

1 AN ACT relating to agriculture and declaring an emergency.

2 ***Be it enacted by the General Assembly of the Commonwealth of Kentucky:***

3 ➔Section 1. KRS 246.055 is amended to read as follows:

4 (1) The Department of Agriculture may accept federal aid, **nonfederal funds and**
5 **grants**, gifts, donations, or devises~~[- The Department of Agriculture is authorized in~~
6 ~~its discretion to accept the provisions of any Act of Congress appropriating,~~
7 ~~granting, or apportioning funds or commodities to the state for use in connection~~
8 ~~with any program of the Department of Agriculture. The Commissioner shall~~
9 ~~prescribe for the proper apportionment and distribution of these funds, property or~~
10 ~~commodities in accordance with the state and federal laws].~~

11 **(2) For use in connection with any program of the department and for the benefit of**
12 **programs under its control and supervision, the department is authorized to do**
13 **any of the following:**

14 **(a) Accept provisions of any Act of Congress appropriating, granting, or**
15 **apportioning funds or commodities to the state;**

16 **(b) Receive funds appropriated by the General Assembly, or from any other**
17 **source identified in subsection (1) of this section;**

18 **(c) Provide for the proper apportionment and disbursement of such funds in**
19 **accordance with state or federal laws; or**

20 **(d) Accept and provide for the administration of any nonfederal funds or**
21 **grants, gifts, donations, or devises from any source public or private.**

22 **(3) [(2)]** The Commissioner of Agriculture may enter into any agreement and carry out
23 the terms of such agreement with any department of the federal government, **or**
24 **state or local public agency**, to handle funds, commodities or any devise under any
25 program assigned to or handled by the Department of Agriculture.

26 ➔SECTION 2. A NEW SECTION OF KRS CHAPTER 247 IS CREATED TO
27 READ AS FOLLOWS:

1 (1) As used in this section:

2 (a) "Extension service" includes the University of Kentucky Cooperative
3 Extension Service or the Kentucky State University Cooperative Extension
4 Service;

5 (b) "Initiative" means the Kentucky Urban Youth Agriculture Initiative
6 established in this section;

7 (c) "Program" means any educational program that is part of the initiative;
8 and

9 (d) "Urban county" means a county with a population of one hundred fifty
10 thousand (150,000) or more according to the most recent federal decennial
11 census.

12 (2) There is hereby established the Kentucky Urban Youth Agriculture Initiative,
13 which shall be administered by the University of Kentucky Cooperative Extension
14 Service and the Kentucky State University Cooperative Extension Service and
15 their individual offices within the Commonwealth in partnership with other
16 organizations as appropriate. Beginning January 1, 2027, the extension service
17 shall initiate a pilot program in one (1) or more individual offices. Beginning
18 September 1, 2027, and as funding allows, the extension service may begin full
19 implementation and evaluation of the pilot program in all appropriate offices
20 throughout the Commonwealth, with potential program scaling and expansion to
21 begin September 1, 2028.

22 (3) The initiative shall:

23 (a) Promote farming, agriculture, agribusiness, and the efficient use of land in
24 urban counties;

25 (b) Educate program participants on all aspects of farming, agriculture, and
26 agribusiness in an urban environment and encourage the adoption of urban
27 agriculture best practices;

1 (c) Develop participants' skills and knowledge to become informed agriculture
2 consumers and advocates; and

3 (d) Advance age-appropriate, experiential, or work-ready agricultural and
4 agribusiness programming, including formal internships and
5 apprenticeships.

6 (4) The length of each program term shall be one (1) year and each term shall begin
7 in September on a date specified by each extension service. Programs shall be
8 available to applicants at each extension service office located within or serving
9 an urban county of the Commonwealth. An office may work with an existing
10 state or local agricultural organization to better provide for the administration of
11 a program and the initiative.

12 (5) Each extension service office administering a program shall accept and review
13 applications from eligible applicants. Program participation shall be at the
14 discretion of each office and shall include as many participants as is practicable
15 on an annual basis. To be eligible to participate in a program, a participant shall:
16 (a) Be at least five (5) years of age and no more than eighteen (18) years of age;
17 (b) Have obtained parent or guardian permission to participate in accordance
18 with the extension service's youth protection policies; and
19 (c) Be available to participate in the program for the full duration of the term.

20 ➔ Section 3. Whereas under the Department of Agriculture's current authority, the
21 department is unable to apply for several available privately funded grants that, if
22 awarded, would greatly impact agriculture in the Commonwealth, an emergency is
23 declared to exist, and this Act takes effect upon its passage and approval by the Governor
24 or upon its otherwise becoming a law.